WHAT IS AN MCP SERVER?

MCP is an open standard that lets AI apps connect to tools and data in one common way.

Think of **USB-C**. One standard port instead of a different cable for every device. MCP is that for AI apps: one way to connect to files, databases, GitHub and more.

THE PIECES

Part	Role
Host / client	The AI app (a chat app or coding assistant) that wants to use tools
MCP server	A small program that exposes tools and data in the standard format
Tools	Actions the AI can ask for (search files, create an issue)
Resources	Data the AI can read (files, records)

HOW IT FLOWS

```
You ask the AI ──► AI app (client) ──► MCP server ──► your tool or data
        answer ◄── AI app ◄── result ◄──┘
```

WHY IT MATTERS

- Build a connection once, and any MCP-compatible app can use it.
- The AI works with real, current data instead of guessing.
- You control what each server can access, so only connect servers you trust.

LEARN MORE

Official docs: modelcontextprotocol.io



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